12-08 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Small Brown Dog We Brought in from the Snow

① On the evening of the fourth snow, a Tuesday, at around **18:40**, my father and I were walking home from the corner shop with a bag of eggs and a carton of warm milk when we heard something small crying at the foot of the old poplar tree at the north gate of our compound. The snow had stopped, but the wind was still sharp. The lights of the compound gate gave the whole courtyard a yellow, quiet glow, the colour of a warm old lamp. My father held up his hand: *"Yiran, wait."* I waited. Under the poplar tree, half-buried by fresh snow, a **very small brown dog** — no bigger than a Chinese cabbage — was shivering, eyes half closed, one front paw lifted off the frozen ground. She had no collar. Her fur was wet and speckled with small white flakes that were already, in the wind, turning into tiny ice. She made one small, tired sound. Then she was quiet.

② My father knelt down, very slowly, so as not to frighten her. He spoke in a low, calm voice: *"Little thing, little thing, don't be afraid."* She did not run. (She could not have run — her legs were trembling too hard.) Dad took off his grey scarf, wrapped her completely except for her small dark nose, and lifted her against his chest like a baby. "Yiran," he said, handing me the bag of eggs, "run home. Turn on the radiator in the spare bathroom. Lay two old towels on the floor. Boil a pot of warm water for her feet — **warm, not hot**, warm like a summer puddle." I ran.

③ In the lift I met our neighbour, Uncle Ma from the sixth floor. He looked at the shaking bundle in my arms — I had taken the dog from my father on the third-floor landing to carry the last two floors because his coat had become wet — and said, simply, *"Stray?"* I nodded. Uncle Ma did not ask any more questions. Instead he said, *"Xiao Yiran, there is a roll of gauze in my kitchen drawer. And a very old baby blanket from when my son was small. Knock at my door in ten minutes — I will bring them."* Our building, I realised then, was **a small quiet team I had not properly seen before**.

④ At home, Mother was already moving. By the time we arrived, the bathroom radiator was warm, the floor had two old clean towels, and a small basin of warm water (just above body temperature, measured by Mother's elbow, the old way) sat in the corner. Dad set the small dog on the towels. She looked up at us with **small wet eyes**, bright and careful. She was, we guessed, about **two years old** — young, thin, not a puppy. I could see her ribs through her fur. Dad dried her with a slow, soft motion, front leg first, so we would not frighten the hurt one. The hurt paw, we found, had a small cut from a broken bottle — probably in a distant doorway, days ago. Mother cleaned it with warm water and a small drop of salt, wrapped it in Uncle Ma's gauze, and fed the dog, with a spoon, two teaspoons of warm rice water — nothing heavy, because a starving small animal

must be fed slowly, we had read last year when our school had a lecture on winter strays.

⑤ For the first twenty minutes the small brown dog simply stared at us, as if not quite believing she was indoors. Then, after a while, her body began to warm; her breathing became slower; her tail, still wet, moved once — a small, hesitant flick. *"She is deciding,"* Dad said. *"Whether to trust us."* Mother nodded. "Take your time, little thing," she said softly, and put a small old cotton T-shirt — mine from Grade 3 — on the corner of the towel, so the smell in the room would soon include the smell of people who would stay. The dog smelled it, very seriously, and curled up on it.

⑥ At 19:40, Dad went back out with a flashlight and asked the two gate uncles whether anyone had lost a dog. Nobody had. We called the local police stray-animal hotline — recorded voice said the wait was forty minutes; we waited. At 20:25, a kind young officer called back. He said the dog had no registered microchip; no matching lost-dog report had been filed this week; we could either take her to the city animal shelter (14 km away) tomorrow morning, **or**, if we agreed to take full legal responsibility starting now, he could register us as **temporary foster carers**. Dad looked at Mother. Mother looked at me. I looked at the small brown dog, who was now — unbelievably — asleep. I nodded. Dad said into the phone, *"Temporary, please. With a view to adoption if nobody claims her in thirty days."*

⑦ We named her, very carefully, **Xiaoxue — Little Snow** — after the evening that brought her. The next day, after breakfast, we took her to Dr Zhao, the old vet at the small clinic two streets down, who looked her over carefully and said the foot was clean, her lungs were healthy, her teeth were about two years old, she weighed **3.1 kg** and was about **2 kg underweight**. She gave us a small bag of kind food, three pages of handwritten instructions, and one last quiet sentence: *"Feed slowly. Love slowly. Little things like this remember."*

⑧ Four weeks later, today, as I write this on our kitchen table, Xiaoxue is sleeping on my feet, about **4.2 kg now**, her ribs no longer visible, her fur soft, brown, a little shinier. She has learned to follow me to the front door when I leave for school, stop at the small mat, and sit. She knows her name (*xiǎo xuě*, pronounced with a small question). Her limp is almost gone. Last Saturday, she chased a falling leaf in the courtyard, almost fell sideways on the icy stone, and my father laughed so loudly that two old aunties turned to look. I think she has decided to stay. I think we decided **a little more slowly than that**.

⑨ The lost-dog search on the city app found nothing, all 30 days. No phone call. No old family. The adoption papers are being quietly prepared by Dad in his careful handwriting. Uncle Ma, from the sixth floor, is already the unofficial uncle of Xiaoxue. The old gate uncles have taken to keeping a small bowl of water near the gate, "in case her small friends come too."

⑩ Tonight, before bed, I wrote three lines in my diary:

Dec 8. Fourth snow. Poplar tree, north gate, 18:40. Warm scarf, warm water, warm rice-water.
Uncle Ma, gauze, old blanket, Mother's elbow-temperature test.
Little Snow — 3.1 kg then, 4.2 kg now, one small decision of trust made on a towel four weeks ago.

I looked down at the dog asleep on my feet. **The world had been a little cold on December 8th**, but a small brown thing — and the quiet team of people around one small brown thing — had, between us, made one small warm room. I closed the notebook gently, so as not to wake her.

注释： stray 走失动物；gauze 纱布；microchip 芯片；foster 临时照料；rice water 米汤

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Where and when did the writer and her father find the small brown dog?

A. In a school corridor at 10:00 in the morning.
B. At the foot of the old poplar tree at the north gate of their compound on the evening of the fourth snow, a Tuesday, at around 18:40, when the dog — no bigger than a cabbage, with no collar, one front paw lifted, half-buried by fresh snow — was shivering in the cold wind.
C. Inside their apartment.
D. At the corner shop.

2. Who from the building helped the family with a gauze roll and a very old baby blanket?

A. The building manager.
B. A delivery man.
C. Uncle Ma from the sixth floor, who quietly said "Stray?" in the lift, then told the writer he would bring "a roll of gauze and a very old baby blanket from when my son was small" when she knocked at his door in ten minutes.
D. A schoolmate.

3. What did the police officer offer when he called back at 20:25?

A. He told them to throw the dog outside.
B. He said the dog had no registered microchip and no matching lost-dog report; the family could either take her to the city animal shelter 14 km away the next morning, or, if they agreed to take full legal responsibility starting now, he could register them as "temporary foster carers."
C. He said the family had broken the law.
D. He said the dog already had an owner on the second floor.

4. Four weeks later, how has Xiaoxue (Little Snow) changed?

A. She has grown from 3.1 kg to 4.2 kg, her ribs are no longer visible, her fur is softer and shinier, her limp is almost gone, and she has learned to follow the writer to the front door, stop at the mat and sit, and to recognise her name.
B. She is now 10 kg and afraid of people.
C. She is exactly the same as when they found her.
D. She has run away.

5. What is the main message at the end of the story?

A. Strays are always dangerous and should be left alone.
B. The world had been a little cold on December 8th, but a small brown thing and the quiet team of people around her — father, mother, Uncle Ma, the vet, the gate uncles, the police officer — had, between them, made one small warm room; the decision of trust, made on a towel four weeks ago, was a quietly shared one.
C. Only the police should handle strays.
D. Animals cannot remember kindness.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段相遇
【解析】"北门 / 杨树 / 18:40 / 雪"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段马叔
【解析】"六楼 / 纱布 / 老婴儿毯"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段电话
【解析】"无芯片 / 无报失 / 两个选择 / 临时寄养"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段
【解析】"3.1 → 4.2 / 门口坐 / 名字"直引。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑩段结尾
【解析】"小团队 / 一间暖房 / 信任"主旨。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。